Yu-Chen Chao (趙于楨)

Accounting and finance graduate · empirical research on digital payments and bank income

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PROFILE

Accounting and finance graduate with a completed empirical research project on digital payment pressure and bank net fee margins in an ASEAN-3 bank panel. Comfortable across the whole workflow: building a clean panel dataset, estimating fixed-effects models with clustered standard errors, testing robustness, and stating clearly what the evidence does and does not support.

EXPERIENCE

Co-founder and technical lead, TechStarterWeb Consulting October 2026 – present

- Built the studio's trilingual website and its order back office (Astro, Cloudflare) with an AI coding agent.

Intern, tax advisory team July – September 2025

Evershine CPAs Firm (永輝啟佳聯合會計師事務所)

- Prepared and checked the supporting documentation for Philippines tax incentive applications.
- Mapped the application process and turned the standard operating procedures into flowcharts used by the team.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Accounting and Finance September 2024 – June 2026

University of Birmingham · Singapore · Campus: Totally Taught Abroad · English instruction

Degree to be conferred 12 November 2026 · Class II (Division I) · overall weighted mark 61/100 · GPA 3.25

SIM Diploma in International Business April 2023 – June 2024

SELECTED PROJECTS

Digital payment pressure and bank net fee margins 2025 – 2026

Final-year research project · **report component 80/100 (65% of module; module total 77/100 on transcript)** · above the upper quartile (73), top 25%; cohort maximum 84

- Built the bank-year panel, joined an IMF Financial Access Survey indicator, and estimated bank and year fixed-effects models with bank-clustered standard errors in Python.
- Reported the results as conditional associations and published the design, documentation, and limitations as a public research report.

Mobile money adoption in the Global South Business Analytics module

Business Analytics: 70/100 · equal to the upper quartile (70); cohort maximum 76

- Mapped 437 coded World Bank Findex fields across 174 economies and 12 population groups into 24 business-readable measures, then excluded two waves for coverage, leaving 171 economies and four waves (2014–2024).
- Published a five-dashboard Tableau story on mobile money adoption, with findings on Sub-Saharan African adoption, digital payments running ahead of debit cards, the savings gap, and women's financial participation.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming: Python 3.14 (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, linearmodels, matplotlib, openpyxl), pytest, uv, Git and GitHub with a continuous-integration workflow.

Econometrics: panel data with bank and year fixed effects, bank-clustered standard errors, winsorisation, log and interaction specifications, subsample robustness.

Analysis and reporting: Tableau dashboards and data stories, advanced Excel, financial statement and bank margin analysis, cross-border tax documentation.

Languages: Chinese (Mandarin), native; English, the language of instruction for the degree.